

SEASON 01 EPISODE 02

Westside

1 **EXT. LOUIS'S DRIVEWAY - DAY** 1

LOUIS and JUNIPER, a bear and a labrador, bounce handballs on each others' driveways. They play tag. Laughing and giggling.

2 **INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY** 2

BELINDA, Louis's mother, watches.

Saturday on the calendar.

Across the street, through the window: JANE, Juniper's mother, on the porch. A solemn stare.

Belinda gets up.

3 **EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY** 3

Door unlocks. Just as Belinda opens the door, Jane gets up to leave.

BELINDA
Hey! What's your name?

Jane closes the door quietly. Belinda crosses the divider and knocks.

4 **INT. JUNIPER'S HOUSE - DAY** 4

Jane leans on the door.

BELINDA (O.S.)
Y-you in there?

JANE (O.S.)
Name's Jane.

BELINDA (O.S.)
You wanna open the door, Jane?

5 **EXT. JUNIPER'S HOUSE - DAY** 5

Jane opens the door.

BELINDA
Belinda.

JANE
What?

BELINDA
Belinda is my name. My name is
Belinda. Is he your only kid?

Jane stares at the ground, averting eye contact. She rubs her eyes.

JANE
Wh- what do you want?

BELINDA
Nothing. I just wanted to say hi.

She slowly lifts them, up to Belinda's face.

Belinda. Eyebrows raised, hunched and minimmized, trying to look approachable.

Jane doesn't buy it. She closes the door.

BELINDA
Okay- I'm glad your son and mine are able to play!

Belinda turns around, heads back home. She calls her husband. On the phone:

6 EXT. TAILOR SHOP - DAY

6

HENRY, Louis's father, threads a needle. Using a sewing machine with his big hands.

HENRY
Ah!

His cell rings. Henry looks around, answers it.

BELINDA (O.S.)
Where's Hazel?

HENRY
I thought she was with you. She said she'd be back home by noon.

BELINDA (O.S.)
(sighs)
Okay.

Click. Henry nearly pieces his hand. His fur gets matted.

HENRY
Shit, shit shit shit-

7 EXT. WESTSIDE - DAY

7

Finally, HAZEL- Louis's sister- wanders down the pavement. She glances at each house.

She glances at the extremes. Some houses are big, like theirs, others tiny.

Yellow, unwatered grass. Creaky fences. Toys left in the yard.

Big or small, all of westside is united in mess.

8 EXT. WESTSIDE PARK - DAY

8

Hazel sits by a park, a nearby thing of benches.

A nearby black bear- SIENNA- and his kermode friend- KODY- sit at the park, playing with dice.

SIENNA

Dude, no. You don't hit on 15, you stay.

KODY

I thought you hit if you think the other guy has enough high cards.

SIENNA

Hey you!

Hazel glances around.

SIENNA

Yeah, you! Come here.

Hazel eyes them. Down and up. They're bears. The only bears she found.

SIENNA

Hey. Are you new?

HAZEL

(points)

Me?

Kody smacks Sienna.

KODY

You're weirding her out. Stop it.

But Hazel approaches.

HAZEL

Yeah, what about it? You got a problem with another bear in town?

The wind blows. But Sienna scoffs, casual.

SIENNA

(smirks)

Nah. I wanted to get your thoughts on this.

Sienna plays his cards.

SIENNA

You know how to play Blackjack?

HAZEL
My uncles taught me before I moved
here.

SIENNA
From where?

HAZEL
Lakos.

SIENNA
Oh shit, we're from Lakos too.

HAZEL
Dude, I thought I was going crazy.
It's like no one here knows what
that even is.

SIENNA
I dunno. It's a small world.

Kody plays another card. Hazel watches intently.

SIENNA
Hit or stay?

KODY
(mumbling)
Hit.

Sienna passes another card. Kody smacks his lips, does a
loser lap around the benches.

He reveals his deck. 7. 8. KING.

Over 21.

Sienna chuckles.

SIENNA
You're over 21, bitch. See? See what
I said?

Hazel chuckles.

HAZEL
Can three play?

Sienna and Kody smirk at each other. Kody nudges Sienna.

9 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

9

Belinda leaves. Turns the corner.

10 EXT. WESTSIDE PARK - DAY

10

Sienna deals. Belinda turns the corner.

She gasps.

BELINDA
Hey! Hazel! You promised you'd be
home by 12!

HAZEL
I'm just playing!

BELINDA
Play at home!

HAZEL
But-

BELINDA
Hazel! That's an order!

Hazel sighs, leaves for home.

KODY
Is that her mom?

SIENNA
No shit, you think it's her cousin?

Kody smacks his lips.

SIENNA
Hey, Hazel!

Hazel turns around.

SIENNA
We play every Tuesday!

Hazel gives Sienna a thumbs-up. Belinda leads her away.
Not before double-taking at the only two other bears in
the neighborhood.

11 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

11

Hazel sits on the couch of the living room. Arms crossed.
Henry, now home, hangs his coat. He picks at the fur on
his fingers.

Outside, Louis and Juniper dribble. Kid laughter.

HAZEL
What the fuck, Mom?

HENRY
Language!

HAZEL

Why is Louis able to play but not me?

(points)

Why me?

BELINDA

Because you're the older sister. You promised you'd be home by 12 so that you could cook.

HAZEL

Is it actually that? So then why does Louis get to play with a dog but me not with a bear?

BELINDA

It's not about that.

HAZEL

Yeah it is. You didn't even introduce yourself or anything. But when it comes to Louis's friend, you let them play in our front yard like it's nothing.

Belinda rolls her eyes.

HAZEL

Liar.

Hazel gets up and storms off.

HENRY

Don't call your mom a liar-

SLAM!

BELINDA

Henry.

Distant sizzle. The fish starts cooking. Belinda glazes out the window.

12 EXT. WESTSIDE PARK - DAY

12

Earlier, glancing at Sienna, she remembers.

FLASHBACK:

13 EXT. LAKOS - DAY

13

A sign: Welcome to Lakos.

Belinda walks the street. Bears, big animals, tower over her. Purchasing fish. Stained armpits on tanktops. Pickaxes. Men covered in soot. Women with aprons.

Vendors, smoke, ash, tar, orange.

14 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

14

Belinda snaps to.

Over the table:

HENRY

Hazel!

(sighs)

Can we call Louis?

BELINDA

It's fine, just let him finish playing.

Henry grabs a bite. Window open.

HENRY

You okay?

Belinda sighs, rubs her arms.

BELINDA

Babe, I- I think-

HENRY

Don't. You're wearing yourself out.
We just got here, so of course our
anxieties are all over the
fuckin'...

Belinda leans on her palm.

BELINDA

Louis officially starts tomorrow.

HENRY

And Hazel.

Belinda drops her fork and sits. She gets up, places her food in a fly-proof container, and leaves.

Henry sighs.

15 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

15

Hazel leaves the house, holding Louis's hand.

She turns around. Locks the house with a spare key.

The car gone from the driveway.

16 EXT. WESTSIDE - DAY

16

Hazel passes by the park. No one there.

17 EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY**17**

Hazel reaches a pair of bushes. The tracks are an obstacle.

HAZEL
How the hell...

LOUIS
What's wrong, big sis?

HAZEL
It's like these tracks go on for
like-

LOUIS
Why don't we just cross?

HAZEL
No, Louis, we can't do that.

LOUIS
(looks)
But there aren't any trains.

Hazel hesitates. Looks for an exit. Loops back.

HAZEL
(sighs)
Okay. Just this once.

Louis nods. They hold each others' hands- leap over the tracks.

18 EXT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY**18**

Hazel and Louis pause. Then sigh- enter.

19 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY**19**

Animals- big and small- all around the hallways.

Hazel notices: SIENNA AND KODY.

HAZEL
(gasp)
Hey!

Sienna and Kody are surrounded by a bunch of other large animals. They high-five Hazel. She breaks off.

HAZEL
(to Louis)
Just find the classroom at the end
of the hall!

LOUIS

Okay!

Louis walks, enters the room. The teacher- Mrs. MARCHECK-sits on a tall chair.

MARCHECK

Have a seat!

Louis looks around. The room's a mix of big and small, people on the rug.

Louis sits down, glances. Everyone's glancing at the teacher.

Louis leans to a medium animal. A RABBIT.

LOUIS

Hello.

He bares his teeth.

The rabbit's eyes go wide. She gulps. Then slightly moves away.

Louis scratches his head.

The bell rings.

MARCHECK

Long ago, there were three kinds of animals who lived on this land.

Mammals...

(elegant)

Avians-

(monstrous)

And reptiles!

The kids scream, then laugh.

MARCHECK

They all sat on one big island together, searching for a world where they could all live in harmony. But alas-

The teacher makes a whooshing sound. But Louis isn't paying too much attention. He pokes the same australian shepherd.

LOUIS

(whispering)

My name's Louis!

MARCHECK

One day, other islands were
(MORE)

MARCHECK (CONT'D)
discovered off the mainland! And
since then, the world's creatures
have been spread across the world,
sprinkled in faraway lands vastly
different from our own.

Most kids stare on as the teacher turns the pages.

MARCHECK
Since then, mammals, the stewards of
the mainland, venture out and seek
more answers to the history of our
world.

CLASS
Ooh.

Louis keeps poking. The rabbit turns around.

RABBIT
(whispering)
Stop it.

Suddenly, the marcheck whips her head in his direction.

MARCHECK
Is everything-

RABBIT
This bear keeps poking me.

She stares right at Louis.

MARCHECK
You know, it isn't nice to poke,
dear.

LOUIS
I'm sorry Teacher.

The teacher blinks, raises her eyebrows, sighs. The facade
disappears for a moment.

But then she closes the book.

MARCHECK
Any questions? May I continue?

CLASS
Yes!

MARCHECK
Alright then.

She flips the page.

In another class:

RODRIGO
Ten times ten is what?

CLASS
One hundred!

Hazel blinks, confused. She writes 100 on her paper.

A brief violin creeps into cadence.

20 INT. BARBER SHOP - DAY 20

Of Belinda cutting hair.

21 INT. TAILOR SHOP - DAY 21

Of Henry threading a needle.

22 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 22

Of Louis staring at the rabbit he poked earlier-
whispering to other mice and small animals.

23 EXT. WESTSIDE PARK - DAY 23

During lunch, Louis sits at a table with Hazel.

Sienna and Kody seem to ignore him. Only talking to her.

SIENNA
Hit or stay?

HAZEL
Hit.

SIENNA
Hit or stay?

KODY
Stay.

Flips. Hazel wins. She gets up and celebrates.

SIENNA
That's right. Fuck you and your mom,
Kody.

KODY
Can your brother play?

The boys size Louis up.

HAZEL
He's still really young.

SIENNA

Ight then.

Sienna passes the next set of cards.

Louis gets ready to leave, but-

RABBIT

Hey!

The rabbits come up to Louis's food.

RABBIT

What's that?

Louis's ears rise. He smiles.

Hazel can tell something's up. She squints.

LOUIS

It's halibut! My dad loves making
it. What's your name?

The rabbit picks up a piece of halibut. She sniffs it.

RABBIT

Ew. What is this?

She tosses the halibut off to Louis. Louis looks shocked.
His eyes dart, unsure what to do.

But the rabbit doesn't stop there. She picks up his entire
meal and one by one begins to throw it onto the floor.

HAZEL

Hey, hey, hey!

The rabbit trashes the rest of his meal.

RABBIT

That's what you get for poking me.
I'm not scared of you.

LOUIS

I just wanted to be friends.

RABBIT

Well too bad. My name's Harley. I
already forgot yours, fatty.

The rabbits walk away, giggling. Louis glances back at his
food. He frowns and buries his head in his arms.

Sienna raises his eyebrows.

SIENNA
 You gonna let 'em get away with
 that, lil' bro?

Louis shakes his head. But his head is still buried in his arms.

KODY
 You good?

Louis shakes his head again.

Hazel's breathing grows quicker.

The bell rings.

AFTER SCHOOL:

Animals getting picked up at the parking lot. Hazel watches as the harlequin rabbit is picked up by her parents-

Who are dressed with tucked clothes and soft, pampered arms.

24 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

24

The family eats dinner.

BELINDA
 So?

Louis eats his food slowly. Then he picks up the pace.

HAZEL
 Someone threw away Louis's lunch.

Belinda pushes her chair backward.

BELINDA
 Excuse me? And he just let them do that?

HENRY
 Why would he let them do that?

LOUIS
 She did it so fast.

HENRY
 Next time, you say "no." Got it?

Louis nods.

Henry gets up, annoyed. He washes his dishes.

HAZEL
What? What?!

HENRY
(quiet)
Nothing.

Henry closes the door to the room. Belinda comes after him. They hear whispers in the room.

HAZEL
Yummy, right?

Louis nods.

25 EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY 25

They glance at the train tracks. They look at each other, then both ways.

And they cross.

26 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 26

Hazel writes.

27 INT. BARBER SHOP - DAY 27

Belinda styles.

28 INT. TAILOR SHOP - DAY 28

Henry sews.

29 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 29

Louis draws in class.

30 EXT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 30

People getting picked up. Hazel excuses herself for a moment. Louis is left alone. He brings out a drawing.

31 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 31

Louis's crayon cracks.

LOUIS
Aww man...

32 EXT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 32

The harlequin rabbit comes back to him.

RABBIT
Hey.

LOUIS

Hey.

RABBIT

Mom told me to say sorry after
yesterday.

LOUIS

It's okay.

The rabbit brings out her drawing.

RABBIT

We drew today. Can I see yours?

LOUIS

It's so cool! Is that a rainbow?
Wait, here's mine.

Louis brings out his. It's sloppy- flimsy.

The rabbit glances at it. Her facade cracks.

RABBIT

(judgy)
Who's that?

LOUIS

(excited)
This is mommy, and this is daddy,
and this is my sister, Hazel.

RABBIT

Hazel. Can I see?

The rabbit holds out her hand for a closer look. Louis
hands her the paper.

A wide grin spreads across her face.

RABBIT

Thanks.

The rabbit RIPS it in half.

Louis gasps.

LOUIS

Oh no! No, no, no no!

The rabbit runs away, giggling. Hazel returns, running
back.

HAZEL

(panting)
God, are you kidding me?!

33 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

33

Louis stares at the sheet of paper. Henry tapes it back together.

HENRY
See? Good as new.

Hazel quietly works, resigned. Belinda sighs and rubs her forehead.

In the bedroom, with hushed voices:

HENRY
I told you. The principal told you.
He warned you that the school wasn't
supposed to be for us bigger folk.

BELINDA
Okay, but that? That's different. I
get it if you call my kid *fat*,
because us bears- but that?

HENRY
I told Hazel... That when you're a
kid-

BELINDA
(angry whisper)
You gave him that naive bullshit?!

Henry wrinkles his nose. With contempt.

Belinda backs down. She sighs.

LATER THAT NIGHT:

Belinda tucks Louis and Hazel in bed.

Louis stares at his hands.

BELINDA
What are you doing, Louis?

LOUIS
Mom?

BELINDA
Yes, Louis?

LOUIS
I feel dumb.

Louis stares at his paw.

34 **EXT. LAKOS - DAY**

34

Belinda stares at hers.

35 **INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

35

Belinda stabilizes.

BELINDA

You're not. And anyone who tells you
that can go suck a fat one.

HAZEL

(grinning)

Mom!

Belinda chuckles.

BELINDA

They can, though. And see how I said
that without using any cusswords? I
didn't say fuck, or shit, or bitch-

HAZEL

Mom!

Louis's eyes widen. He laughs.

BELINDA

So you shouldn't be saying that
either.

Belinda pets Louis and Hazel. Hazel's eyes water at the
touch of her mother.

BELINDA

You two... I want you to grow up to
become big strong kids, so that you
can have kids of your own... Good
jobs... Good life...

Belinda steps back, raises a finger.

BELINDA

So when you two have to fight for
yourself, use your words, say no.
Don't hit. Don't say anything
vulgar. But fight. You understand?

The kids nod.

BELINDA

Attakids.

The door closes.

LOUIS
Hazel?

HAZEL
Yeah?

LOUIS
I love you.

HAZEL
I love you too, Louis.

The light turns off.

36 EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY 36

They cross it, holding hands, natural.

37 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 37

TEACHER
And can anyone tell me what seven
times three is?

Hazel pauses. She smirks.

CLASS
21!

The bell rings.

In the kindergarten class, the rabbit glances at Louis,
makes a face at him. Louis smiles back at her.

In the math class, Hazel hears a knock by the wall. She
raises her hand.

HAZEL
Can I use the restroom?

38 EXT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY 38

Louis runs outside, playing tag with all the kids. Hazel,
Sienna, and Kody turn the corner.

They begin playing blackjack at the lunchtables.

But Hazel notices, at the corner of her eye:

Louis.

Louis tags left, then right. He notices the rabbits
whispering again. He knows it can't be good.

The teacher whistles.

MARCHECK
Everyone line up for dodgeball!

A disproportionate number of people head toward one team.

MARCHECK
Up up up! Balance!

Louis doesn't realize. Several of the rabbit's friends head to Louis's side.

The game begins. The rabbit friends out themselves immediately.

Then more of Louis's side gets out. Louis doesn't realize they're missing him. He dodges balls not even coming his way.

Then finally, it's just him on one side, the rabbits on the other.

Hazel glances back up, then down, then up, as she realizes something going on.

Louis looks around.

RABBIT
Get 'im!

Louis's eyes go wide.

LOUIS
No!

The first ball throws. More come in.

Louis tries desperately to dodge.

LOUIS
No! Stop! Stop! This isn't fair!

They throw more.

LOUIS
They were missing me on purpose!
Teacher!

The teacher squints at the people on the left, then on the right.

He's out.

MARCHECK
Okay, game's over!

The rabbit and her friends throw more and more at him. They continually hit him.

LOUIS
Stop! Stop!

Bigger animals' eyes widen. Smaller animals cheer. Mrs. Marcheck gets in the way and stops it. She blows her whistle.

MARCHECK
Detention! Detention for you! Who?
Who else planned this?!

But it's too late. Louis runs off.

MARCHECK
Hey!

Hazel slowly gets up, chases after Louis.

39 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY

39

She catches him in the hall.

HAZEL
Louis! What's wrong?

LOUIS
They hate me. Big sis, they hate me.

HAZEL
Who? Who did this, what happened?

LOUIS
They threw dodgeballs at me.
(angry sobs)
I could've hit them. I could've hit them if I wanted to. But I didn't. I listened to Mom and Dad and said no.

Hazel continues to hug and brush him.

LOUIS
What did I do wrong? Big sis, what did I do wrong?

Hazel's eyes well.

HAZEL
Nothing. Nothing. You did nothing wrong.

Sienna and Kody turn the corner.

SIENNA
Hey Hazel!
(stops)
Oh, shit. Go, go, give 'em room.

They go back.

The rabbit runs to them, a frown of sorry on her face. But her friends stop her.

Hazel opens her eye and notices them. She glares.

The rabbit runs.

40 EXT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY

40

Hazel stomps through the parking lot. Louis grabs her leg, trying to stop her. She nudges free.

She walks right up to the rabbit.

Just as the rabbit's parents arrive out of the car-

Hazel glares at them, then PINS the rabbit against the wall.

PARENT

Hey. Hey! Hey, what are you doing?!
Hey!

HAZEL

Do not mess with me or my brother.
(manic)
Yeah?!

RABBIT

(shaking)
Yeah! Yeah, yeah!

Hazel lets her go.

PARENT

Hey!

HAZEL

(points)
She has been bullying my brother for
the past week!

RABBIT

No I haven't! I haven't, I didn't
realize-

SMASH CUT TO:

41 INT. BARBER SHOP - DAY

41

A call comes in.

BELINDA

Hello?

Belinda crosses into the tailor shop.

42 INT. TAILOR SHOP - DAY

42

BELINDA
Henry, the principal's calling.

HENRY
What? Babe, I'm working.

BELINDA
No, we're being called. It's Hazel.
Hazel, she-

HENRY
(smacks lips)
Okay, who's going?

BELINDA
You, of course!

HENRY
You're the one who has them
registered with all the paperwork!

BELINDA
So!

HENRY
So you go!

BELINDA
It doesn't matter- we don't have
time for this?
(on phone)
Hello? Be there.

Belinda slams the line. The phone falls off it.

Henry picks it up, fuming.

43 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY

43

The principal's office. A mouse.

Belinda approaches from the hallway, a look of anger on her face.

She grabs Hazel first.

HAZEL
I thought I was doing the right
thing.

BELINDA
When you get home...

HAZEL
No, please, Mom, please.

LOUIS
Mom.

Belinda lowers Hazel.

The door to the office closes.

PRINCIPAL
I have no choice but expulsion if
you can't convince me that your kids
will be fine from now on.

BELINDA
My kid said she thought she was
doing the right thing, but we
clearly have more work to do. I'm so
sorry. To you and to your kid-

Belinda tries to touch the parent's shoulder, but the
parent flinches.

She retracts her hand.

BELINDA
It won't happen again.

PRINCIPAL
(sighs)
Is that all?

PARENT
I think this is an issue of
malnutrition and who's being fed
what. If a kid is poorly situated at
home, it can contribute to episodes
of irritability, and I think-

PRINCIPAL
Listen, you two.

BELINDA
Oh yeah? How's this for
irritability?

Belinda reaches into her purse and pulls out the ripped
piece of paper.

BELINDA
Your kid ripped this. My kid told me
your kid ripped this in class-

PARENT
I know my kid like the back of my
(MORE)

PARENT (CONT'D)
hand, I give her everything she
needs, there is absolutely no chance
she did that.

BELINDA
Really? Because my kid came *crying*
home-

PARENT
My kid, too! She said someone poked
her in class-

BELINDA
Poked her? Seriously, that's what
this-

PRINCIPAL
(snapping)
Hey, hey hey! Here!

Belinda and the parent pause.

PRINCIPAL
I'm letting you off the hook *once*,
because there's clearly a
misunderstanding here. But- but talk
to your kids, and figure things out.
Be- be adults.

Belinda's eye twitches.

PRINCIPAL
Yes. You hear me?

The parent nods. Belinda follows.

Belinda BURSTS out of the office.

BELINDA
I had to leave work for this. Come
on.

44 EXT. TAILOR SHOP - DAY

44

Henry gets in the car. It's quiet.

The sun is setting.

45 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT

45

Blue hour.

Belinda reaches the house.

Across it, Jane stares. With a smoke, she sighs. A quiet,
lonely sigh.

46 **INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT** 46

The door closes. The blinds shut.

47 **EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT** 47

Jane perks up. She leans forward.

Quiet. Too quiet.

Speaking into the air:

JANE

Maybe it's time we really make
friends with that bunch. What do you
say, June?

48 **INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT** 48

Belinda hangs up the keys.

HENRY

Babe, the manager said if you leave
like that again, he'll have to fire
you.

Belinda pauses. She turns around.

BELINDA

Get in the room, kids.

LOUIS

Mom?

BELINDA

Get in the room.

The door closes. Hazel holds hands with Louis. Her breath
ragged and quick.

Through the muffled door:

A shrill-

BELINDA (O.S.)

Why?!

Louis and Hazel flinch. They hug each other tight.

49 **EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT** 49

Jane stands, shocked.

BELINDA (O.S.)

(roaring)

Why?! Why?

Her eyes go wide.

50 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT

50

BELINDA (O.S.)
What's wrong with this *fucking*
family?

Hazel and Louis hug each other tight.

In the lobby:

Henry blinks. A single tear streams down his cheek.

51 INT. LOUIS'S OLD HOUSE - NIGHT

51

We're in Lakos.

The old home.

There's old furniture, pickaxes, soot everywhere.

Local news on the TV.

REPORTER
Temperatures searing at 50 celsius
today...

Henry looks directly at Belinda.

BELINDA
Does all this work mean nothing to
this family?!

REPORTER
...Danger of heat stroke, and make
sure not to get too much in your
lungs today...

BELINDA
Do we learn *nothing*? Did we leave
for nothing?

REPORTER
...Asthma rates higher in Lakos,
thanks to proximity to the local
coal mines...

Old family photos in the house. Belinda's family.

HENRY
(through gritted teeth)
We didn't leave for nothing. It's
like I said, we've only been here
for like a-

BELINDA

A week! A week and this is hell! We bought a house, we have a down payment, we have everything and we just *can't*.

52 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

52

Jane blinks, dumbfounded. She glances at her smoke.
It's gone out.

53 INT. LOUIS'S OLD HOUSE - NIGHT

53

Louis and Hazel hug tight.

HENRY

Belinda, it's okay.

Henry approaches Belinda to touch her, but she smacks his arm.

BELINDA

It's not okay-

HENRY

Well then it's *not*!

Henry breaks.

HENRY

It's not okay!

BELINDA

There it is!

Henry slams the counter.

54 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

54

Jane's eyes dart everywhere. He's disgusted.

55 INT. LOUIS'S OLD HOUSE - NIGHT

55

HENRY

It's not okay, but you aren't doing *shit* to make things actually better!

BELINDA

What do you mean?!

HENRY

You focus on what we're *not* doing! What we're not getting right! You wanna talk about naive bullshit?! *This* is some naive bullshit!

Henry takes Belinda's scissors and THROWS them out the window. It crashes.

Louis and Hazel flinch.

BELINDA
Well glad you can admit it!

Belinda's eyes, wide- she grabs the sewing machine and SMASHES IT.

Louis and Hazel flinch harder.

HENRY
Yeah, so we're all just bullshit,
huh? We're all bullshit to you?
That's what we are?
(punches the air)
Hang up the portraits later, get
them registered for school- you
think I don't know that?!

Belinda backs away.

HENRY
You think I don't give a shit about
our kids? I'm just trying to teach
them kindness so they don't end up
like your mom and dad! Because
they're crazy! They're crazy and
horrible and the reason you wanted
to leave, and now you're acting
just like them!

BELINDA
Really? Really!

Belinda shoves Henry out of the hallway. She approaches the door.

56 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT

56

Belinda fumbles with the keys, SLAMMING the door. Just before she gets in her car, she hears the door close across the street.

Jane has given up.

Belinda glares, gets in the car.

HENRY
Where do you think you're going,
huh? Fucking asshole.

57 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

57

Henry closes the door.

The house is quiet.

Hazel opens the door. She walks out with Louis.

HENRY
She'll be back. Don't worry.

But for the first time, more than an assurance, it feels like a threat.

HENRY
I'll be outside.

Hazel nods. Her body is shaking. Henry sighs. He blew it.

He gets up and leaves, closing the door softly.

Hazel leads Louis to the couch. She grabs the remote.

NEWSCASTER
Bullock is passing a salary bill to
boost canine and bovine salaries-

Hazel changes channels. A rabbit on TV.

She flinches. Switches again. A family of bears on TV.
Dressed in suits.

A false narrative.

They're happy and smiling.

MOTHER
Please pass the casserole, papa.

FATHER
Of course, mama.

The casserole passes. Two kids- Louis and Hazel's age-smile.

Hazel stares down at the ground.

LOUIS
Hazel?

HAZEL
What?

LOUIS
Love you.

Hazel sits and grabs her arms. She glances off to the side.

On the table, the ripped, weaponized drawing Louis made.

58 **EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

58

Henry stares at the house across him. He leans forward in disappointment.

He reaches into his pocket and brings out a smoke.

But just before he places it in his mouth, he dumps it back into the cartridge.

Moments later, the car runs back into the driveway.

Belinda steps out. She walks up to the porch.

Just before opening the door, she walks up to Henry.

They hug.

No I'm sorry. No Let's Forgive and Forget.

Just a hug.

Belinda turns to the house and they both go inside.

As the lights, one by one...

Turn off.

CUT TO BLACK.